**MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM**

**MGU-BVOC (HONOURS) Regular EXAMINATION November 2025**

## First Semester

## Skill Development Components (SDC) – MG1SDCBAJ100

# INTRODUCTION TO TOOLS AND DESIGN – ANSWER KEY

Duration: 1 hour 30 minutes Maximum Marks: 50

Remember(K), Understand(U), Apply(A), Analyse(An), Evaluate(E), Create(C), Skill(S), Interest(I) and Appreciation(Ap)

**Part A MCQ**

**Answer all questions, Each question carries 1 marks**

1. **Which of these is a disadvantage of a WAN? [A] / [CO1]**

   High cost and complexity

2. **What does HTTPS indicate in a URL? [A] / [CO1]**

   Secure website

3. **Which of the following is an example of application software? [A] / [CO1, CO2]**

   MS Word

4. **In Word, which tab is used to insert pictures into a document? [A] / [CO2]**

   Insert

5. **In Word, page numbering can be added via which tab? [A] / [CO2]**

   Insert

6. **Which Word shortcut saves all open documents in Word? [A] / [CO2]**

   Ctrl + S

7. **In Excel, pressing Ctrl + N opens: [A] / [CO3]**

   A new workbook

8. **In Excel, changing the chart style can be done via: [A] / [CO3]**

Chart Tools → Design

9. **Microsoft PowerPoint is a _____ software. [A] / [CO2]**

   Presentation

10. **The shortcut key to open a new browser tab is: [A] / [CO1]**

    Ctrl + T

**Part B: Short Answers (2 Marks)**

**Answer any 5 questions**

**11. Explain the difference between primary memory and secondary memory. [Apply] / [CO1]**

Primary memory (like RAM) is volatile, meaning it loses data when power is off, and is directly accessed by the CPU for active tasks. Secondary memory (like Hard Drives/USBs) is non-volatile, meant for permanent storage, and is slower than primary memory.

**12. State two video file formats commonly used. [Apply] / [CO1]**

1. **MP4 (MPEG-4):** Widely supported, good balance of quality and file size.
2. **AVI (Audio Video Interleave):** Older format, often higher quality but larger file sizes.

**13. Mention two ways in which the Internet helps journalists in reporting news. [Apply] / [CO1]**

1. **Research & Verification:** Journalists use the internet to fact-check, access global databases, and follow breaking news in real-time.
2. **Dissemination:** It allows them to publish stories instantly to a global audience via news websites, blogs, and social media platforms.

**14. List two different file formats in which you can save a PowerPoint presentation. [Create] / [CO4]**

1. **.PPTX:** The standard editable PowerPoint format.
2. **.PDF:** Saves the slides as a document that cannot be easily edited, ensuring fonts and layout stay fixed when shared.

**15. Explain the use of the Tools panel in InDesign. [Create] / [CO4]**

The Tools panel is the central hub for creating and editing. It contains specific tools for selecting objects (Selection Tool), adding text (Type Tool), drawing shapes, and creating frames to hold images (Frame Tool).

**16. Describe how to insert a chart in a slide. [Create] / [CO4]**

To insert a chart, go to the **Insert** tab and click **Chart**. A dialog box allows you to choose the chart type (e.g., Pie or Column). Once selected, an Excel window automatically opens for you to input the data.

**17. Describe how merging columns can help create clear headings in invoices. [Apply] / [CO3]**

In an invoice, merging cells across the top row allows you to create a centered main heading (like "INVOICE" or the Company Name) that spans across all data columns (Item, Qty, Price). This unifies the table and clearly identifies the document.

**18. Explain how aligning text and numbers improves readability in professional reports. [Apply] / [CO3]**

- **Text (Left Align):** Keeps the starting point consistent for the eye, making it easier to read.
- **Numbers (Right Align):** Ensures that decimal points line up vertically. This prevents confusion and makes it much easier to compare values or sum them up mentally.

**Part C: Short Essays (5 Marks)**

**Answer any 3 questions**

**19. Explain two advantages of using cloud storage over physical storage devices. [Apply] / [CO1]**

1. **Accessibility:** Cloud storage allows users to access their files from any device (phone, laptop, tablet) anywhere in the world, as long as they have internet. Physical storage requires you to carry the specific drive with you.
2. **Data Security & Recovery:** Physical drives can be lost, stolen, or damaged (dropped), resulting in data loss. Cloud services typically have redundancy (backups) and allow data recovery if a local device fails.

**20. Describe how headers, footers, and page breaks support navigation and structure in a long document. [Apply] / [CO2]**

- **Headers/Footers:** These provide consistent context on every page, such as the document title, chapter name, or page numbers. This helps the reader know exactly where they are in the document.
- **Page Breaks:** These are used to force content to start on a new page. Instead of pressing "Enter" multiple times, a page break ensures that a new chapter or major section always starts cleanly at the top of a page, maintaining professional formatting.

**21. Explain how guides and rulers help in aligning and organizing content in InDesign. [Create] / [CO4]**

- **Rulers:** Located at the top and side of the workspace, they provide precise measurements (inches, cm, pixels) to place objects accurately.
- **Guides:** These are non-printing lines you can pull from the rulers. They act as a visual grid, helping you align text boxes, images, and headlines perfectly with each other. This ensures the layout looks organized and professional rather than messy.

**22. A journalist is preparing a magazine article — describe how text alignment and line spacing affect the visual appeal of the document. [Apply] / [CO2]**

- **Alignment:** Using "Justified" alignment gives the text clean, straight edges on both sides, which is standard for professional magazines. Left alignment creates a "ragged" edge which is more casual.
- **Line Spacing (Leading):** If lines are too close, the text looks dense and intimidating to read. Increasing the line spacing introduces "white space," making the article look lighter, more inviting, and easier for the eye to track.

**23. Discuss how typography choices in InDesign influence readability and design aesthetics. [Create] / [CO4]**

- **Design Aesthetics:** The choice of font sets the mood. A serif font (like Times New Roman) feels traditional and trustworthy, while a sans-serif font (like Arial) feels modern and clean.
- **Readability:** Typography involves selecting the right font size and weight. Headings should be bold and larger to stand out (hierarchy), while body text must be legible. Poor contrast or overly decorative fonts can make the content difficult to read, frustrating the audience.

**Part D: Essays (15 Marks)**

**Answer any 1 question**

**24. Describe the process of creating and saving a document in MS Word, including different file formats (DOCX, PDF) and folder organization for easy retrieval. [Apply] / [CO2]**

- **Creating:** Launch MS Word and select "Blank Document." Enter your text. Use the ribbon tools to format the font, paragraphs, and styles to create a professional look.
- **Saving:** Click the **File** tab and select **Save As**.
- **File Formats:**
    - **DOCX:** Choose this format if you want to keep the file editable. It is the standard format for Word.
    - **PDF:** Choose this format if you are finalizing the document for distribution. It ensures that the formatting (fonts, images) looks exactly the same on every computer and prevents accidental editing.
- **Folder Organization:** In the "Save As" dialog, avoid saving everything to the Desktop. Use the "New Folder" button to create a specific folder (e.g., "Semester 1 Notes"). Naming files clearly (e.g., "Assignment_1_Draft.docx") and placing them in subject-specific folders ensures you can quickly find them later without searching through a cluttered list.

**25. You are asked to prepare a budget table in Excel. Explain how merging cells and adjusting column width/row height improves clarity and readability. [Apply] / [CO3]**

- **Merging Cells for Titles:** A budget needs a clear title. By selecting cells A1 to E1 and clicking "Merge & Center," the title "Monthly Budget" is centered across the entire table. This creates a strong visual hierarchy, telling the viewer immediately what the sheet is about.
- **Adjusting Column Width:** Default columns are often too narrow. If a cell contains "Miscellaneous Expenses," it might get cut off or overlap. Double-clicking the column boundary (AutoFit) expands the column so the full text is visible. This prevents data from being hidden or misread.
- **Adjusting Row Height:** The header row (Date, Item, Cost) needs to stand out. Increasing the row height adds "breathing room" (white space) around the text. This separation distinguishes the headers from the data rows below, making the table less cramped and easier to scan for specific information.